

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Mona Lott

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Mona Lott

International Cultural Heritage Ambassador

Mona can turn a simple disagreement about a bowl into an international event. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables. Where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural,' Mona shows up with three lawyers and a list of demands.

- Has a long professional friendship with **Sue Venir**. Their arguments sometimes continue through dinner.
- Debates restitution policy with **Dr. Art E. Fact**, who usually brings reading material.
- Secretly wants to fool **Tess Tament** into paying millions for cheap bead necklaces from China.

ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Mona Lott. I negotiate the return of precious objects. I expect several difficult conversations and at least one excellent croissant.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Mona Lott

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant intended to announce that the Star Bowl would become a permanent Meridian holding, undermining months of quiet restitution negotiations and publicly humiliating the international partners you represent.

Your other secret

You leaked the existence of the restitution talks to selected journalists to pressure Grant, even though the negotiations were supposed to remain confidential.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Paige Turner knows you were the leak.
- Get Sue Venir to acknowledge that the legal risk is real.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Mona Lott

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *From Genesis to Revelation, a familiar book offers room for one extra document.*
- 2** *Not every throne is upholstered; check the underside of a metal one.*
- 3** *The artist signed the front. Somebody else has used the space behind it.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Mona Lott

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Mona Lott

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant's permanent-gift announcement would wreck the restitution talks. I leaked the negotiations to the press to prevent that. From 6:39 to 6:45 I dictated a custody amendment in the translation booth to overseas counsel. It keeps a disputed title disputed. He preferred a speech that would make the dispute disappear.

IF MURDERER

Grant intended to announce permanent ownership before our restitution partners could respond. I leaked the talks to the press. I had drafted a custody amendment and left counsel a translation recording. He expected the international representatives to applaud while he cancelled the substance of months of negotiation.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Mona Lott

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Mona Lott

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I saw the bowl early, before its alcove closed. Then I used the booth to work through the title language with counsel. I returned to the gallery with two versions of the amendment and an unusually strong desire to be rude. A diplomatic representative learns to make that desire look like a request for clarification.

IF MURDERER

I checked the ownership wording early and reviewed the translated amendment at the gallery desk. Before the toast I compared the two copies. Grant had offered an announcement instead of a negotiation. I intended to give him the words his international guests would hear when they declined to accept it.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Mona Lott

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Mona Lott

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I leaked a confidential negotiation and kept the contested export copy. Both language versions of my amendment preserve the same objection. Grant had changed 'custody' to 'ownership' in a draft prepared for his guests. I crossed it out. A change of noun can accomplish a great deal when nobody reads the translation carefully.

IF MURDERER

I retained the export copy and two amendments after breaching confidentiality by briefing the press. Grant had changed 'custody' to 'ownership' in the announcement draft. My crossing-out is visible in both languages. He called the leak a betrayal. I regarded his proposed announcement as a breach of the assurances he had given our partners.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Mona Lott

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

**Mona Lott**

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I leaked the talks. Both retained translation-booth recordings account for my presence during the contamination interval. They also show that the custody amendment was ready before Grant's toast. I intended to stop the announcement through an objection his guests could understand. I did not stop it by poisoning its speaker.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

Counsel received my translation recording while I carried the amendments into the salon. I put stolen toxin on the presentation linen and wiped Grant's coupe. He had decided to humiliate the restitution partners publicly. I chose to make his private toast final. The negotiations were real; the continuous booth session was not mine.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.